

meditation on the relationship between God and man.

**“ People should know my tunes and
whistle them. ”**

ARNOLD SCHOENBERG, LETTER WRITTEN IN LOS
ANGELES, 1947

Schoenberg did his best to adapt to life in the US, taking US citizenship in 1941. He taught at California universities and socialized with Hollywood movie stars at his house off Sunset Boulevard. He also wrote some notable works, including the Violin Concerto (1936) and the Piano Concerto (1942), but nothing could bridge the gap between his European elitism and US cultural populism. His declining years were darkened by knowledge of the fate of the European Jews in the Holocaust and by his own failing health. He died following a heart attack in 1951.

Schoenberg's influence on composers of the second half of the 20th century was to be immense. However, his works have never achieved the wide acceptance by concert audiences that he had always believed would one day come.